

Social Sciences TA Evaluation for Benson, Andrew Glen ECON 129 LEC A (62195), Spring Qtr 2020

Responses: 42/68 (61.76%)

ATTENDANCE

1. How often did you attend discussion sections?

- 4 Never
- 1 Once
- 1 2 - 3 times
- 9 4 - 5 times
- 2 6 - 7 times
- 3 8 times
- 22 More than 8 times

2. How often did you meet with the T.A., outside of the section time, to discuss the course material?

- 12 Never
- 4 Once
- 9 2 - 3 times
- 4 4 - 5 times
- 2 6 - 7 times
- 1 8 times
- 9 More than 8 times

PRESENTATION

3. T.A. was competent in course material:

- 1 0 (N/A or Unsure)
- 0 1 (Among Worst)
- 1 2
- 0 3
- 4 4 (OK or Average)
- 4 5
- 10 6
- 21 7 (Among Best)

4. T.A. was able to make presentations clearly:

- 2 0 (N/A or Unsure)
- 0 1 (Among Worst)
- 1 2
- 0 3
- 3 4 (OK or Average)
- 4 5
- 9 6
- 22 7 (Among Best)

5. T.A. was responsive to students:

- 1 0 (N/A or Unsure)
- 0 1 (Among Worst)
- 1 2
- 0 3
- 2 4 (OK or Average)
- 2 5
- 5 6
- 30 7 (Among Best)

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6. T.A. was able to integrate the lecture and discussion material:

- 1 0 (N/A or Unsure)
- 0 1 (Among Worst)
- 1 2
- 0 3
- 3 4 (OK or Average)
- 3 5
- 7 6
- 25 7 (Among Best)

7. T.A. was present and on time for discussion sections/office hours:

- 2 0 (N/A or Unsure)
- 0 1 (Among Worst)
- 1 2
- 0 3
- 3 4 (OK or Average)
- 1 5
- 7 6
- 26 7 (Among Best)

8. The discussion sections were useful to the success of the course:

- 2 0 (N/A or Unsure)
- 0 1 (Among Worst)
- 1 2
- 0 3
- 2 4 (OK or Average)
- 3 5
- 8 6
- 25 7 (Among Best)

9. I would expect another course with this T.A. to be:

- 1 0 (N/A or Unsure)
- 0 1 (Among Worst)
- 1 2
- 0 3
- 3 4 (OK or Average)
- 2 5
- 7 6
- 27 7 (Among Best)

EFFECTIVENESS

10. Rate your T.A.'s general teaching effectiveness:

- 0 Poor
- 0 Inadequate
- 0 Less than adequate
- 3 Adequate
- 2 More than adequate
- 9 Very good
- 26 Excellent

COMMENTS

11. *<No question text>*

1. What were the strongest points of the TA in discussion section or office hours?

- Able to explain materials clearly. Willingness to help. One of the best TA's I have had in this school.
- Absolutely amazing TA. Very knowledgeable and very helpful. Wished I had him for every course. The 7s I gave him were definitely well-deserved!
- Andrew was readily able to answer our questions! He was very accessible, understandable, and clear with his explanations. It was a pleasure to have Andrew as my TA!
- He answered students' questions quickly by using the discord channel.
- He was very helpful and provided a different avenue to provide help and was there when the students needed extra help. He also discussed student concerns with the professor.
- He was very responsive, I don't think he missed any questions directed to him, he even created a discord server to make it easier for everyone to contact him and for him to reply to any questions in real-time, among the best TA's (if not the best) I have had the pleasure to have.
- He was very responsive and clear in his discussion sections. He really strives on making sure students aren't left in the dark with the material.
- His availability and knowledge
- I've had Andrew as my TA for all three quarters this year, and in every single course I had him, his discussion sections and office hours were extremely useful. He is very resourceful, and he is more than willing to work out any problems with you. It is evident that he puts a lot of effort in being a wonderful TA. He is always ready to answer any questions, and that felt especially reassuring with so many uncertainties and unknowns in a fully remote academic setting.
- I would say this TA is probably the best TA I have ever had in any class in college. This TA's strongest points are that he was responsive; he would response to every question about anything, he was very helpful for the homeworks. especially in the discussions, he made amazing examples to help understand the material and the homework, he made it very clear he cares about the students understanding and want all students to succeed as he really makes himself available pretty much every day this quarter making it very easy to receive help for anything needed and this TA just really went the extra mile with things he did, like helping prepare for the exams and he even helped to set up a easy excel table to calculate grades to make students easily understand their situation and if they should maybe change to pass or fail for the grading. It is incredible to have such a helpful TA in the situations of a pandemic and other events and he was just amazing for helping in this pandemic. I think he took an awful situation and showed his true abilities as a TA with great success in this pandemic. I do not know how he was able to work through it with how many questions came his way, but he seemed to answer them all and still make sure to go an extra step every moment to make he was not just solving a question, but also helping everyone truly understand the question and how to work them out. He did a great job and anyone having him as a TA in the future are very lucky.
- Kind
- Making himself available for contact at practically all hours of the day. He communicates excellently with students and provides resources to make learning easier. He went above and beyond.
- nice and patient
- respond fast and clearly
- TA Benson made a Discord server where we could post questions and comments, in addition to meeting up with other students and working together. It definitely helped a lot in terms of better understanding the material and connecting with students in the same, or similar majors. It meant that Benson was almost always available and he always gave thoughtful and helpful responses.
- TA Benson was more than happy to meet and talk to students outside of discussion section or office hours, even late at night. He is an advocate for students, which everyone appreciates.

- The Discord server was really really helpful, as it gave us real-time responses and help. It was also useful for students to discuss with and help others.
 - The T.A. is very patient and his instructions are very clear.
 - The TA explained complicated stata stuff and was very understanding. His discussions were helpful to do the homework since he showed how to use stata and what the concepts meant. He is helpful and kind. Thank you.
 - This is one of the best TAs I have ever had the pleasure of learning under. Andrew was always active and present in the discord whenever he was needed. I felt like he really cared about the students and being there for us when we needed him to explain the complicated program that STATA is. He really worked with us and I really appreciate that. I also feel like he was a great facilitator between the students and the professor and I am glad that he was our TA this quarter.
 - Very easily accessible and helpful on Discord. Assisted and clarified lots of problems that the class had in a prompt manner throughout the course. Discussion section were responsive to student feedback and clarified difficult topics from lecture.
 - Very good examples given in discussion, more in-depth compared to lectures. Very helpful outside of class, on Discord especially.
 - 20 blank answer(s).
2. Do you have any recommendations for your TA that would help that person be a more effective TA in the future?
- be more prepared and explain more detailed
 - Considering the current situations that we find ourselves in, I do not think I can make any recommendations (maybe obtaining a better microphone but that's not necessarily a recommendation more of a suggestion.)
 - Honestly, no I do not have any recommendations as he did an amazing job and really the only thing I think I can say is to keep doing what he did this quarter as it was very helpful and students will be glad to have a great TA that truly understands the material and goes the extra step to help make sure everyone has a great understanding.
 - I can't think of any.
 - I have no recommendations, Andrew was a great TA who came prepared and was consistently available within reasonable times everyday.
 - I remember that there were a couple of times where Andrew's command lines didn't really follow through on the Stata output and I got a little lost. However, this didn't really impact the discussion that much as Andrew was a great TA and was still able to help and explain the concepts very well!
 - I would say pay attention to the lectures more often so you can help students with lecture material. Also, sometimes discussion material can be kind of chaotic. Follow the discussion agenda more clearly and write the do-file beforehand so you can follow along.
 - Keep some form of online access (Discord, Piazza, etc.) even outside of courses affected by COVID. The online accessibility really helps the class.
 - No
 - No
 - No, his formatting of discussion is perfect!
 - No, very good overall.
 - none
 - No need for improvement.
 - Not so much on the TA, but better communication from the professor through the TA to students would be much more helpful. Some questions from the students cannot solely be answered by the TA (like grading options) so I feel that it would be more helpful if the professor and TA were more on the same page.

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- Not sure.
- The T.A. could create shorter names for variables in STATA.
- Yes. Please teach more classes!
- 24 blank answer(s).